

FALL ARTS 2025

SEASON'S
THEATER

Our top 10 from "Amadeus" to an Alicia Keys musical. A+E



MARC J. FRANKLIN

LIFE+TRAVEL

Muslims seeking Muslims

From apps to matchmaking: the diverse ways some American Muslims navigate finding love, marrying.

REAL ESTATE

Trend to private listings

Who benefits when a home listing isn't shared far and wide? Agents weigh quiet exclusivity vs. big exposure.



By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

VATICAN CITY — Gazing at the lavish Italian-style gardens and intricate topiaries of the pope's vast summer estate just outside of Rome, a local priest who immigrated to Waukegan from Mexico as a child marveled that he's been entrusted with their care.

The grounds are home to the Vatican's seminal ecological project, the Borgo Laudato Si', a 135-acre experiment in sustainable farming and environmental education. It's designed to serve as a model for intertwining the protection of both creation and often-vulnerable populations such as migrants, refugees and those in poverty, said the Rev. Manuel Dorantes, the initiative's managing director and a longtime Archdiocese of Chicago priest with deep ties to several area parishes.

"We all need to come together to be able to promote environmental sustainability and uplift human dignity, especially of the most vulnerable," Dorantes, 42, said.

Chicago native Pope Leo XIV formally inaugurated the Borgo Laudato Si' on Friday, declaring that "care for creation is truly a vocation for every human being."

'A seed that can bear fruits of justice and peace'

Pope Leo XIV launches Vatican's groundbreaking ecology project directed by a Chicago priest

Above: The Rev. Manuel Dorantes walks the grounds of Borgo Laudato Si' on May 20 outside Rome. Dorantes moved from serving in Chicago to Italy after being appointed by Pope Francis as the administrative management director of the Laudato Si' Center for Higher Education in 2024. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

During the dedication, the Holy Father reaffirmed his commitment to ecological preservation and education, carrying on the legacy of his predecessor Pope Francis, whose writings inspired the Borgo Laudato Si'.

"What we see today is a synthesis of extraordinary beauty, where spirituality, daily life and technology dwell together in harmony," the pope said during his visit according to Vatican News. "It is a place of closeness and convivial proximity, and a seed that can bear fruits of justice and peace."

The inauguration featured a performance by renowned Italian opera singer Andrea Bocelli and his son Matteo. The Holy Father toured the project grounds, fed fish, petted horses and celebrated a liturgy for the program's students, workers and their families.

The sprawling roughly 2,000-year-old property includes ancient Roman archaeological sites, farmlands, pontifical villas and lush papal gardens, with areas for organic farming and regenerative cultivation. More than 3,000 plants from 300 species thrive on the land, Dorantes said.

The site also houses the Laudato Si'

Turn to Dorantes, Page 9

Enrollment plummets at regional universities

The schools are facing significant challenges with no easy solutions

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

MACOMB, Ill. — Swinging their pompoms in sync, the Westernettes danced in the sun on a recent Friday morning as the Marching Leathernecks played their traditional tune "Let's Go 'Necks!" in the shade.

Three days before classes were to start, the dance team and marching band performed before a large crowd outside the College of Fine Arts and Communication Recital Hall on Western Illinois University's main campus. This was a celebration of sorts, warranting an appearance by Ray, the school's beloved English bulldog mascot clad in a WIU sweater of purple and gold.

Inside the recital hall, the school's president, Kristi Mindrup, took the stage with other university administrators and mentioned the school's enrollment figure in 1973 of 15,469 — three times the roughly 5,100 estimated enrolled this school year. But she urged attendees not to dwell on the past, quoting former President Theodore Roosevelt: "Comparison is the thief of joy."

"WIU will be successful at any size because of our people and our dedication to our mission," Mindrup said during the Aug. 22 event. "There is one question: Are we ready to let go of what we were and to lift up where we are now in order to evolve into what we will be?"

With enrollment dropping drastically over the last two decades, WIU is in the same company as many Illinois public regional universities. Sometimes called directional universities, the schools representing geographical areas of the state, including Eastern Illinois University, Northern Illinois University and Southern Illinois University in Carbondale, are facing some of their most significant challenges in modern times in attracting students.

The enrollment drop is part of

Turn to Schools, Page 14

INSIDE



A "No Guard" sign is held up at the Mexican Independence Day Parade. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/TRIBUNE**

Lower turnout at parade as Trump portends actions

President Donald Trump set the stage for a surge of immigration enforcement with a social media post depicting military helicopters flying over Chicago with the title "Chipocalypse Now." In Pilsen, there were fewer people but the same pride at the Mexican Independence Day Parade.

Stories in Chicagoland, Page 3

Johnson's new speed cameras see big early revenue

Aldermen tout safety impact, but resident reactions more mixed

By William Tong and Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

The black box blinked once. Twice. Attached to a light pole on South Ashland Avenue, the newly-minted speed camera flashed a total of eight times in about 30 seconds one August afternoon, cars zooming by after cruising off I-55 a few blocks north.

Drivers ticketed for speeding there on June 1 — the first day the camera went online — have so far paid the city more than \$60,000, in increments of \$35 and \$100.

It's a drop in the municipal bucket for Mayor Brandon Johnson's citywide camera expansion

Turn to Cameras, Page 2



A speed camera fires its light as vehicles pass in the 7100 block of North Sheridan Road in the Rogers Park neighborhood of Chicago on Aug. 26. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

